***Altnordische Philologie: Norwegen und Island.* Odd Einar Haugen (ed.) Astrid van Nahl (trans.). 2007. Berlin/New York: Walter de Gruyter. 653pp. $277.**

The present volume is a collection of articles dedicated to various subfields of Old Norse philology, and it is a German translation of the original Norwegian edition, *Handbok i norrøn filologi*, published in 2004 by Fagbokforlaget in Norway.

Altnordische Philologie is divided into ten chapters, dealing with the following topics: manuscript and archive studies (J.G. Jørgensen), textual criticism and philology (O.E. Haugen), runology (K.F. Seim), paleography (O.E. Haugen), Eddic and scaldic poetry (E. Mundal), the Old Norse sagas (E. Mundal), syntactic development (M.A. Nielsen), onomastics (I. Særheim), comparison of Old Icelandic and Old Norwegian (J.R. Hagland), and Middle Norwegian (E. Mørcke).

As stated by the editor, the purpose of this collection was to produce a brief and yet informative introduction to Old Norse philology, which would be easily accessible to novices in the field as well as the broad public outside academia. Such a focus of this book surely makes it of rather limited value to advanced students of Old Norse philology, but those more familiar with the field will nevertheless find various useful things here. Among these, one could mention the brief summaries of important secondary literature provided at the end of each chapter, which are very convenient due to the vast amount of such work that has been produced in this field in the course of time. Besides, in certain chapters, the reader will find concise discussions of such topics as the classification of manuscripts, the development of script in medieval Norway and Iceland, abbreviation conventions in manuscripts, the development of runes, the earliest runic inscriptions, post-classical Old Norse phonological developments, etc. The book also contains numerous illustrations of early Norwegian and Icelandic manuscripts (with transliterations) as well as a number of runic inscriptions (followed by brief commentaries), a detailed bibliography (extending over more than 30 pages), and a list of Old Norse internet resources.

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***Les contraintes métriques dans la poésie homérique: L'emploi des thèmes nominaux sigmatiques dans l'hexamètre dactylique.* Alain Blanc. Leuven/Paris: Peeters. 2008. 487pp. 48€.**

It is a safe bet that few Indo-Europeanists or Classicists—perhaps even relatively few metricians—will curl up with this volume to savor, cover to cover, its 450 pages of metrical analysis. That is a pity, since those who do will be rewarded with a meticulous, elegant, engagingly written, and important study of Homeric meter, with interesting repercussions for the study of Homeric language generally.

This work is the fruit of Blanc's long and deep engagement with Greek *s*-stems, beginning with a 1987 doctoral thesis on Greek *s*-stem adjectives, followed by nearly a dozen articles on related subjects, including a foretaste (Blanc 2007) of the metrical delights in the present volume. Not surprisingly, then, Blanc displays absolute mastery of the material; and luckily for the reader, he offers lucid presentations of the metrical data, accompanied by skillful and stimulating analyses. His stated goal (14-15) is disarmingly simple: he aims to determine which sigmatic forms (and in which case forms) are capable of fitting into the Homeric hexameter, and then to investigate the means used by the bards in order to circumvent the problems posed by the unmetrical types. After an introductory chapter on the structure of the hexameter, he proceeds to a nearly exhaustive description of *s*-stem forms of all word shapes and their behavior in Homeric verse.[1] The purely descriptive detail

[1] Blanc omits, without comment, *s*-stems in -ας of the type Hom. κῶας 'fleece', which often have oblique-case forms identical to those of ordinary *s*-stems (cf. Hom. κώεα,

Blanc uncovers is often interesting in itself; but the essence of the work—its signal contribution—consists in the many interpretive analyses that arise from the data Blanc has so painstakingly collected.

Already in the introductory chapter, Blanc sounds a recurring theme that makes this work of direct interest to everyone interested in Homer, namely the question of whether certain marked metrical patterns are or are not correlated with artistic effects. Thus, in a discussion of hiatus at the bucolic diaeresis (25-26), Blanc points out that if the fourth foot ends with a vowel-final disyllabic ending (as in *s*-stem forms like acc.sg. ἀ|[4]ναιδέα), elision with a following vowel-initial word is impossible, since that would produce a violation of Hermann's Bridge. Thus, Blanc rightly calls into question previous claims about "expressive hiatus" in such instances (e.g. Ε 568 ... |[4] ἔγχεα |[B] ὀξυό|εντα); and his analyses throughout the book lead him to other such reevaluations. In a similar context (a revelatory discussion of datives in -έεσσι, vis-à-vis -εσσι and -εσι datives; cf. Blanc 2007 in further detail), he articulates a cardinal methodological principle: "Pour chercher à dégager une nuance sémantique ou stylistique propre à certaines formes, il faut en bonne méthode prendre en compte uniquement les formes qui peuvent être en variation libre, en éliminant les autres" (69).

The same fine-grained approach to the analysis of metrical distribution yields many nuggets of insight, at all levels of Homeric diction, ranging from the facts of vowel contraction to the behavior of vocative expressions and patterns of enjambement. Certainly Blanc engages with many of the classic structure points of Homeric rhythmic expression, such as metrical lengthening (219-32 and *passim*), synizesis and contraction (232-36 and *passim*), "strong aspiration" (43, n.2, 166), or overlength (27-28, 207), among many others. Of particular note for this journal's readership are several discussions with comparative Indo-European interest: these include not just a brief appearance of the celebrated κλέος ἄφθιτον and its Vedic cognates (292), but also, within a broader treatment of secondary feminines in -ια (175-80, one of several topics that bear on Greek morphology), an explanation (179-80) for the formation of Hom. εὐρυόδεια, with reference to Simonides' εὐρυεδής, which Blanc convincingly interprets as more archaic than the Homeric formation, in part on the basis of Vedic comparanda (RV *urú ... sádas/sádman*).[2]

Many other *trouvailles* are no less attractive. Even a moderately compendious listing is not possible here, though a few personal favorites may be noted:

- 64 (with n.62): on the enclitic status of γάρ (despite Herodian), as seen in its behavior relative to Hermann's Bridge (a recurring leitmotif in the book) in P 354, cf. τοίγαρ and the testimony of some other ancient grammarians;
- 135: on contracted line-final nom.pl. ... ἐναργεῖς # (formulaic: 1x *Il.*, 2x *Od.*) as a modification of an earlier (though unattested) formula with the frequent line-final nom.sg. type ... ἀεικής/ἀελλής/ ἀληθής/ποδώκης #, etc. (130, n.20);
- 143-44 and 151: intriguing observations about "implicational" rhythmic patterning ("rhythmic equilibrium") for certain contrasting word shapes;[3]

κώεσιν) and which at least in some cases have been secondarily formed to ordinary *s*-stems (cf. Myc. *ko-wo*). It is doubtful that this additional material would have affected his overall conclusions, though one misses discussion of certain features these data display, such as the notorious disyllabic (i.e., unresolvable) dat.sg. οὔδει, 5x *Il.* (to οὖδας 'ground', with gen. οὔδεος and resolved dat. οὔδεϊ; Meister 1921:133-34), cf. Blanc's extended treatment (247-56) of the question of dat.sg. **-i* vs. **-ei*.

[2] It is a pity that, with the sole exception of *ákṣitam* and *śrávas*, Blanc's word index ignores Sanskrit, which in fact makes other appearances. In addition to *urú ... sádas/sádman*: also e.g. *tvac-/-tvacas-* (50, n.21), in an interesting discussion of Hom. σάκος; *sphāyate* (76), in an evaluation of etymological approaches to σπέος, where Hitt. *išpai-*, likewise unindexed, is also cited. (I note in passing that Blanc's assessment of the comparative material possibly related to σπέος ignores the possibility that the IE root is not **speh$_1$-*, but rather **speh$_2$-*, on which see Jasanoff 2003:108-09.)

[3] Here and elsewhere, Blanc effectively mines raw data from O'Neill's well-known study (1942), interpreting them in new and interesting ways on the basis of the *s*-stem material.

• 190-91: on adverbs in -έως of the type ἀσφαλέως, ἀφραδέως, etc. as a "palliatif" for the metrically impossible cretics of the corresponding nom.sg. forms (ἀσφαλής, ἀφραδής, etc.);

• 197-98: a persuasive restoration of elided dat.sg. across the bucolic diaeresis (instead of the transmitted contracted dat.sg. forms) for forms of the type κελαινεφέ';[4]

• 210-11, 213: on the essentially syntactic nature of the relationship between word shape and verse position for voc.sg. forms;

• 229-31: on voc.sg. μοιρηγενές (Γ 182), which (despite Chantraine, DELG s.v. μείρομαι) does not constitute, vis-à-vis μοῖρα, a case of metrical lengthening as such;

• 239-40: a precise explanation (partly involving Hermann's Bridge) for the creation of Hom. νηκερδής and νηπενθής (vs. ἀκερθής [Soph.+], ἀπενθής [ps.-Aesch.+]);

• 322, 324, 328, 433: stimulating observations on disjunctive noun-adjective word order (νόστον ... μελιηδέα [λ100] etc., but never *μελιηδέα νοστον etc., even though this would be metrically well-formed), considered first in terms of marked vs. unmarked orders and then in light of recent findings on such noun-adjective patterns by Dik (2007, esp. Ch. 4), involving the relative discourse salience of the adjective; Blanc appends final remarks (433) on noun-adjective ordering in the early prose of Herodotus and on the post-Homeric development of noun-adjective phraseology with the definite article.

As emerges from the final item above, the last third of Blanc's book confronts *s*-stem behavior with a wide-ranging series of broader features of Homeric diction, including (among other things) hyperbaton, enjambement, and coordination. I was initially skeptical as to whether the restricted focus on *s*-stem material would have heuristic value for features such as these. I needn't have been concerned: in the end, these discussions illuminate all of the areas Blanc considers, and provide a model of how to study productively the interaction of Homeric meter, word shape, morphology, syntax, formula, and style.

Occasional points raise an eyebrow, if not actual concerns. It is hard to take seriously, for example, the suggestion (254) that Mycenaean *s*-stem datives in *-i* (beside the regular consonant-stem dative in *-ei*) could reflect a long [-ī] resulting from a monophthongization of /-ei/. And Blanc oddly calls attention (357, n.8) to the lack of connective after the first substantive at the beginning of PY Jn 829, when in fact this is normal Mycenaean syntax (so also e.g. PY Ta 722.1, in a text Blanc himself otherwise cites [288] in a different context, cf. n.5 below). The real upshot of these quibbles, however, once again concerns indexing: Mycenaean cuts a far from negligible figure in the book,[5] yet the word index omits Mycenaean forms, and the "index des passages cités" omits Mycenaean texts.[6]

Despite the complexities of the subject matter, the book is exceptionally well produced and reader-friendly: the layout is clean (with many lists and charts to assist with orientation among the mass of *s*-stem data), and the material is logically organized and helpfully subdivided. One also appreciates not only the detailed table of contents in the back, but also the synoptic "Sommaire" that precedes the text. Of the dozen or so typos I noted, only a few might cause difficulty (all involving bibliography),[7] along with several inadvertent bibliographical omissions.[8] And apart from the reservations expressed above, the indexing (of subjects,

[4] In this connection: it might have been interesting to consider the background of this famously haplologized form; cf. unhaplologized (but non-occurring) *κελαινονέφης, identical in shape to Blanc's type ἀμετροέπης (208).

[5] In addition to the above: much is made, e.g., of *a-ko-ro-we-e* (224-25), and two Mycenaean texts are studied (288-89) for what they can tell us about preposed vs. postposed adjectives in noun-adjective phrases.

[6] Here note also the erroneous two-word transcription *we-te-i we-te-i* (253, with the same error in the Greek-letter transcription, 254); this āmreḍita compound (13x in PY Es 644!) is never spelled with word division.

[7] At 232, n.47, read "Hackstein 2002, 31" for "Hackstein 220, 31"; "Bartoněk 2002" (253, n.19, 254, nn.21 and 22) refers to a work of 2003 (correctly cited in the bibliography and elsewhere); at 415, read "Higbie (1990, 66)" for "Higbie (1960, 66)."

[8] Lacking entries are "Hajnal 1995" (repeatedly cited: 275, n.1, 275, n.3, 276, n.5, 280-81, 284, n.22), "Guilleux 1997" (275, n.1), and "Luz-Conti-Maquieira 2003" (371, n.26).

authors, Greek words, and cited passages) is excellent.

In sum, the message about this book to each and every *homérisant* is clear: *tolle, lege.*

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New Books

Duhoux, Yves, and Anna Morpurgo Davies (eds.). *A Companion to Linear B: Mycenaean Greek Texts and their World.* Vol. 1. Peeters. 2008. $69.13.

Goldsworthy, Adrian. *How Rome Fell: Death of a Superpower.* Yale University Press. 2009. 544pp. 33 b/w illustrations ISBN 13:978-0-300-13719-4. $32.50. Ultimately, this is the story of how an empire without a serious rival rotted from within, its rulers and institutions putting short-term ambition and personal survival over the wider good of the state. [from publisher's pamphlet]

Kuhrt, Amélie. *The Persian Empire: A corpus of sources from the Achaemenid Period.* 2 vols. Routledge. 2007. 736pp. ISBN 9788-0-415-43628-1. £160, $320. This lavish set of books contains the most complete collection of raw material for reconstructing the history of the Achaemenid Persian Empire to date. Kuhrt presents an unprecedented collection of key texts to form a balanced representation of all aspects of the Empire, in translations from their original Greek, Old Persian, Akkadian, Hebrew, Aramaic Egyptian, or Latin. She selects from classical writers, the Old Testament, royal inscriptions, administrative documents and Babylonian historical writing, as well as the evidence of monuments, artefacts and archaeological sites. All material is accompanied by a detailed introduction to the sources and guidelines to their interpretation. [from publisher's pamphlet]

Langdon, Susan. *Art and Identity in Dark Age Greece, 1100-700 B.C.E.* Cambridge. 2008. $90.

Leskov, A.M. *The Maikop Treasure.* Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology, 2008. ISBN 13:978-1-934536-04-0. x + 294 pp. 316 color illustrations, 4 maps. Hardback $75. The Maikop Treasure consists of more than 300 objects ranging in date from the Bronze Age through the Medieval period, currently held in four institutions—the Staatliche Museen, the Museum für Vor- und Frühgeschichte in Berlin, the Penn Museum in Philadelphia, and the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York. Originally assembled in the 1890s by a wealthy employee of Tsar Nicholas II, these objects have no single provenance but were dug from various sites in the general region of the eastern Pontic. This book is primarily a catalogue [from publisher's website]

Parkin, Tim (ed.). *Roman Social History: A Sourcebook.* Routledge. 2007. 408pp. £70